KAITO YAMADA

SCOUTING REPORT

POSITION: CENTER BACK

Prepared by: **Maryann Mukiebe**
mukiebemaryann22@gmail.com

D.O.B: 31.08.2006, 19 years
Nationality: Japan
Position: Centre Back
Number: 43
Foot: Right
Height: 1.92 m
Weight: 70 kg
Contract end: 30/06/2028

Games Watched:
- Shimizu S-Pulse 1-0 Vissel Kobe
- Vissel Kobe 2-1 Avispa Fukuoka

Minutes Watched: 97 Minutes
Date: 10.03.2026

Overall Summary

- Kaito Yamada, “the Space hunter” is a 19 year old centre back who plays for J1 League cue Vissel Kobe.
- Yamada profiles as a physically dominant, aerially strong central defender with promising tackling and marking ability.
- From the two games, Kaito comes across as a great asset to any team looking to exploit spaces both offensively and defensively. However, his characteristics are greatly cemented in defensive roles.
- He consistently scans for space to receive the ball and demonstrates good awareness when directing teammates on where to move or pass.
- His positioning allows him to anticipate play and manage defensive space effectively.

Strengths

- Applies a good amount pressure from behind helping change players directions.
- Great in defensive aerial duels.
- Anticipates player movements well and frequently intercepts passes.
- Accurate, fast, powerful shot passes.
- Positions himself to exploit spaces in front, starting with a controlled approach before accelerating to close them down.

Areas of Improvement

- Acceleration in open field.
- Minimize moving hands, more so during aerial duel defending (fouled two players in the game vs Avispa).
- Long passes, there were times where he could have played great front balls.

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Defensive Awareness & Game Reading

- **Great positional awareness -** Goes back to position as fast as possible when he is done with the defensive job in any position on the pitch, and this helps him get into position and block any passing options from the opposition.
- **Anchor in a back four** - Takes up the role of the main defender, ad is see organizing his teammates on where to move or where to pass the all to.
- **Pressure on set pieces** - Anticipates and applies pressure during throw-ins and corners, using positioning and body awareness to block passing lanes and prepare for recovery runs toward goal.
- **Short passes** - Uses passing intelligently to maintain team shape under pressure, helping control the game and prevent opposition counter-attacks. In the game vs Avispa Fukuoka he had 83 successful passes at 90.2% accuracy.

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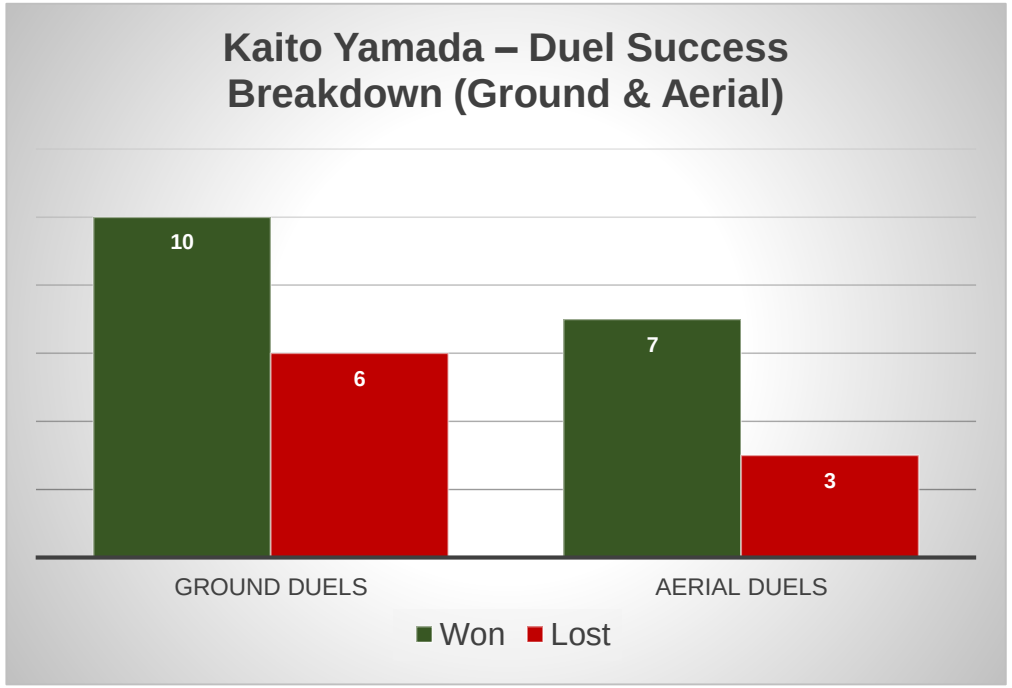
Duels & Aerial Ability

- **Ground Duels Success -** He won 10 out of 16 giving him a 62.50% win rate. This shows he effectively challenged the attackers on the floor highlighting good timing and anticipation that helped him dispossess his opponents.
- **Clearances -** He made 5 clearances in this game, ad thus a great addition to ay defensive lie. He positions himself well to intercept reducing danger for his team.
- **Physical Presence -** He used strong body positioning that helps him lock attackers, shield space, and win all the 1v1 battles. Even when he faces strong opponents, his physically helps him lock any actions from the opponents.
- **Aerial Duels Success -** He won 7/10 giving him a 70% win rate. Kaito has a great ability to dominate in the air and this is essential for defending crosses, long balls, and set-pieces. His height (192 cm) gives him an advantage over most attackers.



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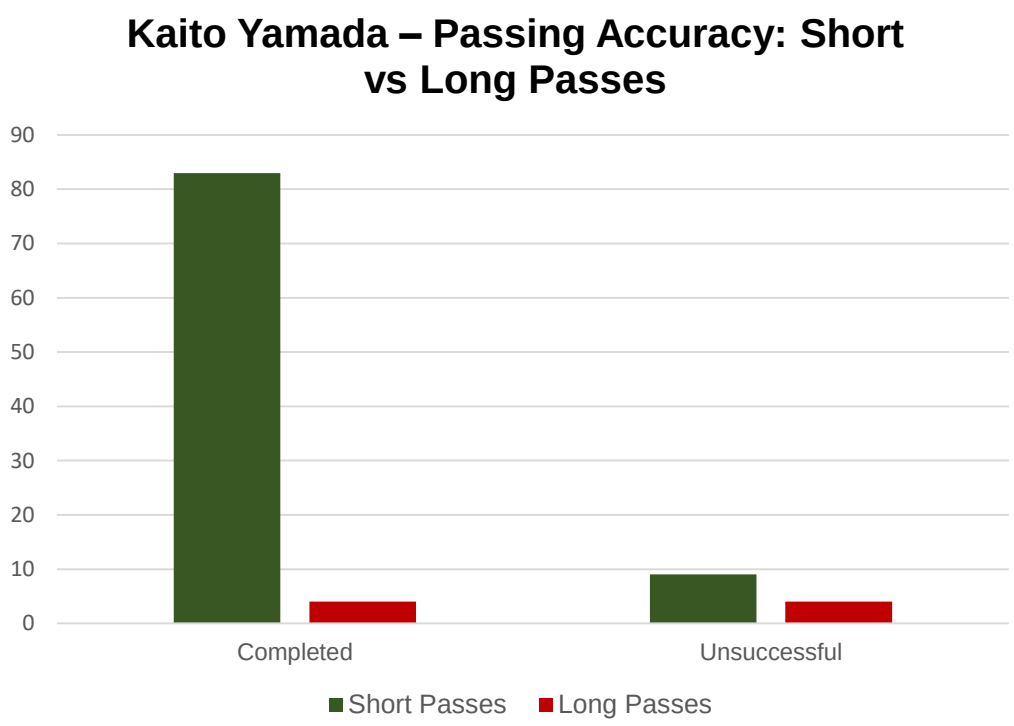
Ball Progression & Passing

- **Short Passing Accuracy -** He had a 90.2% passing accuracy. Completing majority of his passes showed he is reliable maintaining possession, and this is essential in using from the back.
- **Long Ball Accuracy -** He had a 50% accuracy in long balls. This is prove he can switch play or attempt the line-breaking passes, but he needs to develop it for higher competitions.
- **Possession Retention -** Yamada is calm under pressure, and this helps him provide his team with any support needed going in front.
- **Attacking Contribution -** He had a 1 touch in the opposition box, showing how low his offensive contribution is, he needs to increase participation in the attacking phases for an added advantage.



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Recovery, Mobility & Transitions

- **Tracking Opponents -** Dribbled past 2 times and this shows his great ability of cover key defensive channels. He stays in the right positions to prevent attackers from exploiting gaps. Elite defenders combine mobility with tactical intelligence to maintain team shape.
- **Defensive Recoveries -** Yamada successfully made 3 recoveries. He reacted fast after losing the ball, and thus shows a great opportunity of reducing counter attacks and stabilizing his defensive line.
- **Game Awareness Under Pressure -** Yamada is always I position, but I cannot confirm this 100% because I am yet to see him under high-pressure transitions.
- **Sprinting & Transition Speed –** Yamada has a decent pace when tracking counter attacks, but his speed ca improve because most of the times he forces the other center back to step into his position. Improved speed will help him cover any open spaces during fast breaks, providing needed support, and preventing any dangerous attacks.

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Summary & Recruitment Insight

- **Best Use:**
  Central CB who covers the right back, retaining possession, wins duels, and communicate possible passing channels.
- **System Fit:**
  4-1-2-3 or 3-4-3.
  Can fit in a team that emphasizes controlled build up and possession, the team that use mid-block or high-line defensive systems.
- **Development Potential:**
  With consistent playing time, his play can improve greatly.
  Focus areas: attacking involvement, long passes, and recovery under high pressure.
- **Future possible positions:**
  Holding midfielder: Yamada's passing, recovery, off ball intelligence, and physicality, makes him an excellent candidate to transition into a holding midfield role.